4. Authoritarian personality
5. Ethno–centrism
6. Group closure
7. Conflicts

BWU2C2

2. Stereotypes

When prejudice gets stronger, it develops into a stereotype. Stereotype is a false view or idea about something. For example, girls are not good at sports. Stereotype is learned at a very early age, and children grow to have very strong ideas or opinions about things, groups or ideologies. As children grow up, the lines of like and hate for other things, people, cultures, beliefs, languages become sharper.

Example



Ragu was hit in his eye with a soft ball and to everyone's surprise, he started to cry. The others started to laugh at him; Mani felt sad for him but started laughing along with others.

In the above example, we have a general opinion that girls cry and boys don't cry. When Ragu cried out of pain, others laughed at him. Now we understand that when we fix people in our image, we create a stereotype.

Gender-based stereotypes are often portrayed in films, advertisements and TV serials. Almost all the advertisements related to detergents, washing machines, dishwashers and others show a woman as the main lead or user of that product. On the other hand, all the stunts shown in a bike advertisement is performed by ferocious looking men.

3. Inequality and Discrimination

Inequality means difference in treatment. The different forms of inequalities such as caste inequality, religious inequality, race inequality or gender inequality give rise to discrimination.

Discrimination can be defined as negative actions towards people. Inequality and untouchability are caused by discriminations based on caste, religion and gender. Treating dark-skinned people differently from fair-skinned people, and denying equal status, rights and opportunities on the basis of colour, caste, gender, religion etc. are the formidable discriminatory trends afflicting India.

Article 15(1) of the Constitution states that the State shall not discriminate against any citizen on grounds of religion, race, caste, sex, place of birth.

DO YOU KNOW?

End of Apartheid

After 27 years in prison, former South African President, Nelson Mandela, was freed in 1990 and succesfully achieved the end of apartheid in South Africa, bringing peace to a racially divided country and leading the fight for human rights around the world.



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